

6.3 The Wireless Home

We are currently at a point where most new technologies get adapted into our lifestyle without too much fuss. Wireless is fast becoming one such technology. Many of us own more than one computer or communication device such as a laptop, PDA or the cell phone. Our personal and professional data is often scattered between these devices, and obviously, we need to have all our data available to us all the time. The solution to this issue is undoubtedly wireless networking.

Our previous *Fast Track* (May 2005) book exclusively dealt on everything Wi-Fi. In this chapter, we will only discuss connecting a PC and a Wi-Fi-enabled laptop in a home networking scenario.

Setting Up Ad-Hoc Mode

Adhoc-Mod or Peer-to-Peer mode as it is commonly known, is easy to set up and comes with multiple advantages such as creating a network between two or more notebooks that are Wi-Fi-enabled and share small files during meetings. It doesn't need an access point as one of the notebooks can be turned into a soft access point (AP) and the rest can connect to each other through it. The following is a stepwise explanation of how to turn a Wi-Fi-enabled laptop into a soft AP and configuring the rest to connect to it. We will use Windows to get the Wi-Fi up and running.

1. To set up a soft AP, click **Start > Connect To > Wireless Network Connection**. This will open up the 'Wireless Network Connection' dialog box. Here, click 'Properties' and a new dialog box will open from where we need to assign various settings.
2. In this dialog box, under the 'General' tab, scroll to Internet Protocol (TCP/IP) and select it. Now click 'Properties', which will take you to the next dialog box where we need to assign the IP. Just assign the IP and click on the subnet mask once and it will appear automatically.